B1 Writing

Writing an informal email

How to open, organise and close a friendly email, with useful phrases.

An informal email to a friend should sound natural and warm. Use contractions, short paragraphs and a clear reason for writing.

Structure

Part	Useful phrases
Greeting	*Hi Sam, / Dear Anna,*
Opening	*Thanks for your email. / How are things? / Sorry I haven't written for a while.*
Main reason	*I'm writing to tell you... / Guess what? / I wanted to ask you...*
Details	*By the way... / Also... / Anyway...*
Closing	*Can't wait to hear from you. / Write back soon. / See you soon!*
Sign-off	*Love, / Best, / Take care,*

Model email

Hi Sam,

Thanks for your email. It was great to hear about your new job!

I'm writing because I've got some news too. I'm coming to London next month for a short course. Are you free on Saturday the 12th? We could have lunch and catch up.

By the way, do you know any cheap places to stay near the centre?

Write back soon.
Love,
Maria

Avoid formal phrases such as *I would be grateful if* or *Yours faithfully* in an email to a friend.

Practice

1. Make it informal: I am writing to inform you that I have passed my exam.
2. Make it informal: I look forward to receiving your reply.
3. Choose a sign-off for a close friend: Yours sincerely / Love

Teacher page: answers

Print the pages before this one for students.

Answers

1. Guess what? I've passed my exam!
2. Can't wait to hear from you. / Write back soon.
3. Love